

**SOLUTIONS³**

Cyberside Chats: Summer Edition

Weekly Recap

Special points of interest:

- New Biometric ID rolls out in Mexico
- The case of Daniil Kasatkin
- Scattered Spiders Strike Again
- What does it mean when life insurance and cyber risk meet?

Welcome to the 7th issue of the Cyberside Chats Newsletter!

This week, interns wrapped up the Incident Response Pathway by analyzing a PCAP file on Hack the Box to uncover signs of brute force and data exfiltration. Using our revised Incident Response Plan, we drafted a detailed report as if Falconi, our mock company, had been the victim of the attack and presented a culmination of the IR deliverables.

On Tuesday, Shannon led a professional development session on conflict resolution. Interns explored different types of conflict, resolution styles, and learned how to apply the SBI (Situation, Behavior, Impact) feedback model. Shannon emphasized active listening, empathy, and assertive communication. Interns also took a

conflict style self-assessment and reflected on how well it described them. This week's Vendor Spotlight featured Chase Berman, a success manager at Future Feed. Interns enjoyed learning about his career path and the services Future Feed offers while asking thoughtful questions.

To close out the week, interns participated in their first Capture the Flag event hosted by Floyd Haynes from Hack the Box. For many, this was their first time competing in a CTF, making it especially important to apply both the technical knowledge and communication skills they've developed over the past few weeks. Congratulations to the Cyber Essentials team for pulling off a close win!



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Vendor of the Week: FutureFeed

This week, interns at Solutions³ met with Chase Berman, a Success Manager at FutureFeed. FutureFeed is a leading Cyber-GRC platform that centralizes governance, compliance, and management workflows, creating a clear path for organizations to comply with cybersecurity frameworks such as NIST SP 800-171.

Operating on a subscription model, FutureFeed guides companies through the CMMC compliance process with clarity and confidence. For organizations interested in CMMC compliance, FutureFeed offers a free ebook, "The CMMC Everything I Need to Know to Get Started Guide", to help organizations take that first

step towards compliance. As a trusted Solutions³ partner for over two years, FutureFeed acts as an extension of our team, empowering clients to meet compliance requirements and confidently pursue Department of Defense contracts.

Mexico's New Biometric ID



Mexico's new biometric ID law is making massive headlines. Recently passed legislation now requires the implementation of a national identity card tied to citizens' fingerprints, iris scans, and a unique ID number. The government says it's a move toward modernization, intended to combat organized crime and help locate more than 111,000 missing people.

But not everyone's on board. Many digital rights groups have dubbed it the "Spy Bill," warning that it opens the door to mass surveillance. Under the law,

authorities could gain access to a centralized database of personal data without a warrant. Critics point to Mexico's troubling track record with state surveillance tech, including spyware used on journalists and activists. The rollout raises urgent questions about where to draw the line between national security and personal privacy.

As a cybersecurity and privacy major, it's hard to ignore the potential for misuse here. Biometric systems can boost security, but without strong safeguards, they risk becoming tools

of control rather than protection. Transparency and oversight should be non-negotiables. If governments want public trust in digital systems, they need to prove they're willing to protect the data as relentlessly as they collect it.

"Amateurs hack systems, professionals hack people." - Bruce Schneier

Can Anyone Be a Cybercriminal Now?

This month, the cybersecurity world was shocked when Daniil Kasatkin, a Russian professional basketball player, was arrested in Paris for allegedly helping carry out ransomware attacks on over 900 organizations.

This begs the question - how does an athlete end up involved in a huge cybercrime operation? According to Kaplan's attorney, Kasatkin barely knows how to turn on a computer, leading many to believe he is being used

as a scapegoat. If this belief is true, there is an increasing chance that common people will be unknowingly used as tools in international cyberattacks.

Regardless of what happens to Kasatkin, his arrest is a demonstration of the evolution of ransomware attacks and how easily a device owned by an individual can, without their knowledge, be weaponized

Scattered Spiders Strike Again!



The Scattered Spiders have made the headlines once again! This past Thursday, the U.K. National Crime Agency arrested four individuals who are thought to be connected to the most recent malware attacks on Marks & Spencer, Co-op, and Harrods. This combined cyber event had a financial impact of £270-£440 million for all these retailers.

This is the third major ransomware attack involving the Spiders within the last month. The first two occurred within the aviation industry, the latest focusing on retail.

With each attack gaining more and more attention, it seems the Spiders are becoming more aggressive in their endeavors, hop-

ping from one sector to another. Such behavior must be highly monitored, and defensive measures must be set up as the Spiders continue their hunt.

Professional Development Series: Conflict Resolution

This week's professional development session gave interns valuable insight on how to navigate conflict resolution in the workplace. Interns explored how addressing conflict effectively can lead to stronger team dynamics, better communication, and overall professional growth.

Key points included understanding conflict and how conflict isn't necessarily a bad thing. Interns learned about three key concepts toward understanding conflict: task-based conflict, relational conflict, and process conflict. Interns were able to understand the importance of

approaching conflict with active listening and empathy when addressing a variety of situations.

This session emphasized the value of open and respectful dialogue using the SBI model, where individuals identify the situation, describe the behavior they've noticed, and conclude with the impact of how it made them feel to strategically navigate different avenues of conflict.

Interns were able to take a short quiz to gauge their conflict style through a few scenario-based questions.

Overall, this session gave interns real tools and approaches that they can carry with them professionally. Whether it's navigating disagreements between coworkers, working in teams, interns now have a stronger understanding knowing how to manage conflict more efficiently.



Life Insurance Meets Cyber Risk

A core tenet of cyber resilience is the ability to effectively identify, mitigate, and disclose vulnerabilities, especially in industries dealing with Personally Identifiable Information (PII) and Sensitive PII (SPII).

A significant collector of this information is the life insurance industry, which includes (1) large insurers that create and sell policies, and (2) brokers, smaller

independent firms that act as intermediaries, helping users compare, purchase, and manage policies.

Breaches affecting life insurance brokers pose a major risk, as they often store multiple types of sensitive data such as names, addresses, Social Security Numbers, health information, and financial records for thousands, if not millions, of clients.

Brokers are often at higher risk because they may lack the modernized IT systems and dedicated cybersecurity resources that larger firms rely on.

As the insurance marketplace has largely shifted to digital infrastructure, the protection of personal data has become more critical than ever, particularly among the smallest brokers.

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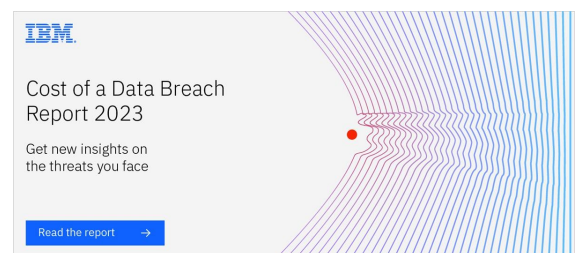
Did You Know?

According to IBM's 2023 Cost of a Data Breach Report, the average breach goes undetected for 233 days, with another 74 days needed to fully contain it. That's nearly 10 months of silent access inside your network.

Breaches lasting over 200 days cost \$4.95 million on average. Even more concerning, Verizon

found that in 90% of cases, attackers exploited known vulnerabilities that had been left unpatched for over six months.

The takeaway is simple: if you're not proactively patching and monitoring, attackers are already making themselves at home.



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At Solutions³ LLC, we believe that empowering people is the key to sustainable success in cybersecurity, IT, and business service management as a whole. Our commitment to resource development is evident through mentorships, advanced training, and workforce development programs, including impactful internships and apprenticeships.

For more information on our internships, workforce development, or training, contact Mike Battistella at mike@solutions3llc.com or Shannon Conley at shannon.conley@solutions3llc.com.

Special Thanks to Our Sponsors

We are grateful for the generous support and partnership of the following organizations, whose contributions help make the Summer Cybersecurity Internship Program possible. Their support enables us to provide hands-on learning experiences, real-world simulations, and invaluable mentorship opportunities for our interns.



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Editor's Corner

Thank you for reading Volume 7 of Cyberside Chats: Summer Edition! I am so grateful to be a part of such a great group of interns and leadership team. I did not know what to expect coming into a remote cyber security internship, but I have been met with an incredible professional learning experience.

I have learned how to leverage my intrapersonal skills through the Professional Development Series as I develop my technical skills through Solutions³ partners like **Hack the Box** and **Infosec Skills**. I've learned many new skills as I navigate programs like Cisco's Packet Tracer and Wireshark for the first time.

Over the course of the Incident Response pathway, I have learned of all the essential

policies and procedures that need to be included on an organization's incident response plan. This incident response plan is critical to the organization's ability to pivot and recover from potential threats.

I am immensely grateful for the opportunity to work with my fellow interns: Aaron, Andre, Amaan, Bryan, Dominick, Jaylen, Jesus, and Jonathen. I also would like to thank **Dr. Yu** and **Felician University** for their continued support.

Additionally, I am thankful for the leadership team of Mike Battistella, Shannon Conley, Kristen Nova, and Mark Marino for giving me the opportunity to learn from them and their sharing of immense industry knowledge.

I most appreciate the learning environment set forth by the leadership team; questions and comments about our work are not just encouraged, but integral into becoming the lifelong learner that is so needed in today's cyber-business landscape.

— Julia Ficon
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